

**Samsung  
SGH-X820**



**Samsung  
SGH-E840**



**Rs 10,999**

+ Slim  
- Build quality

53.17

24.47

19.83

8.88

**Rs 10,700**

+ Great build, slider  
- Keypad tactility

60.34

29.77

21.44

9.12

|                                |                                |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Bar                            | Slider                         |
| Triband                        | Triband                        |
| 220 x 176/2.2"                 | 240 x 320/2.2"                 |
| 256K                           | 256K                           |
| x/x                            | x/x                            |
| 113 x 50 x 6.9 mm              | 101.5 x 52.5 x 10.6 mm         |
| 66 gm                          | 83 gm                          |
| 80 MB (shared)                 | 70 MB                          |
| NA                             | ✓/microSD                      |
| Regular                        | Regular                        |
| 1000                           | 1000                           |
| ✓/✓                            | ✓/✓                            |
| 2.3/210 hrs                    | 3.3/250 hrs                    |
| Proprietary                    | Proprietary                    |
| GPRS, EDGE                     | GPRS, EDGE                     |
| Bluetooth, USB                 | Bluetooth, USB                 |
| 1.2/x                          | 2/✓                            |
| Charger, data cable, handsfree | Charger, data cable, handsfree |
| NA                             | 128 MB                         |
| 6.75/6.5                       | 6.75/6.5                       |
| NA/6                           | 7.25/6.5                       |
| 5/5.25/6                       | 6/6/6                          |
| 7/6.5/7                        | 7/6.75/7                       |
| 4                              | 4                              |
| 4.5                            | 5                              |
| x                              | ✓                              |
| ✓/2 MP                         | ✓/2 MP                         |
| 176 x 144                      | 176 x 144                      |
| x/x/x                          | ✓/✓/✓                          |
| 6.25                           | 5.5                            |
| x/x/✓                          | x/x/✓                          |
| 5/5.5                          | 5.25/6.25                      |
| 4.75/6                         | 5.5/6.25                       |
| 6                              | 6.25                           |
| 5/4.5                          | 5/5.5                          |
| 5                              | 5.5                            |
| 5/5                            | 5.25/5.5                       |
| 4                              | 4.5                            |
| 6.75                           | 6.75                           |

nonetheless has the second-best camera in this entire test. Excellent colour rendition, great clarity and crispness, with good detail mean both these phones can easily replace a mediocre digital camera. The N73ME also has a brilliant camera, and places a joint third (with the K790i, not part of this category).

The N80's camera isn't as good as those on the other two Nokias—no auto-focus is a big no-no for anyone even remotely interested in cell phone photography. The slider on the N80 is more tactile than the one on the N95. Once again, longevity cannot be commented on, considering our limited duration hands on with these phones.

Sony Ericsson's W950i offers good quality music. The only problem is the poor maximum volume levels. The N73 / N95 duo wins hand down here. The LG KG920 isn't quite in the same league as the other phones when it comes to PMP capabilities.

## Our Conclusion

The **Nokia N95** is a very expensive device but also the most powerful multimedia phone in the market right now. An excellent camera, great keypad, great music, excellent screen, 160 MB of onboard memory, and a fast processor that runs the inbuilt GPS application flawlessly. Our *Digit* Best Buy Silver award belongs here—a topping on an already delicious treat.

Our Best Buy Gold—the **N73 Music Edition**—is a little more down-to-earth, something you (and with luck, we) can afford. This phone has a great camera, superb music performance, and a crisp, large screen.

If you want a touchscreen phone, look at **SE's W950i**—though we can't really recommend it because of the high price tag (Rs 24,995). The 4 GB inbuilt memory is a plus, too.

Nokia's **N80** is a classy-looking phone if you can get past the bulk. For the same price as the N73ME, you get Wi-Fi. You get a less capable camera and music player in return.

**LG's KG920** has a lot of features for the price, but it loses out on ergonomics big time. Still, it's attractive-looking in a unique way!

## Summing It All Up

We've noticed the sharp increase in the number of higher-end phones—Rs 16,000 and above—in the market. Convergence is a keyword with such phones. It's a pleasant surprise to see people demanding more out of their phones. Better cameras, better PMP capabilities, and all-round usability: people have turned demanding, and more importantly, discerning. Earlier all a vendor did was say glibly, "This phone has FM"—done deal, sold. Now customers want to know whether the phone supports Wi-Fi, and whether the Bluetooth supports A2DP. They know their MMCs from their miniSDs! This is a trend we're thrilled to see emerge—may it continue! This trend has also caused prices to fall drastically. Although MRP prices take a while to fall, it's the all-determining street prices that keep plummeting.

By December 2006, India was ranked among the top five cellular markets globally, behind giants like China and the US. By 2008, cell phone penetration is expected to cross the magical 50 per cent mark worldwide. India is expected to contribute upwards of \$25 billion (Rs 1,00,000 crore) as annual revenue by 2011 (current revenues are around a third of that figure). The contributing factor to this growth is, naturally, demand. Demand itself is a function of the binaries of population and necessity on one hand, and falling service provider charges on the other. The recent entry of Vodafone in the Indian market should also be a factor as it will, in all probability, affect international call rates. With domestic rates at an all-time low, many people are actually opting for a second cell phone and entirely doing away with their fixed voice lines.

The only area we're still to see cell phones really penetrate is the data arena where broadband is still reigning supreme, and Internet browsing is largely restricted to mail checking, downloading little themes, etc. Wi-Fi is emerging as a connectivity option, but is largely restricted to airports and certain large shopping malls. Current devices support extremely high speeds, but infrastructure is lacking. Storage is another issue... solid-state drives promise to resolve that one, and we're seeing 16 GB Flash modules penetrate the computer market. More please! ☑

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**BEST BUY**  
**digit**  
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**Nokia N73ME**

The audiophile's delight!